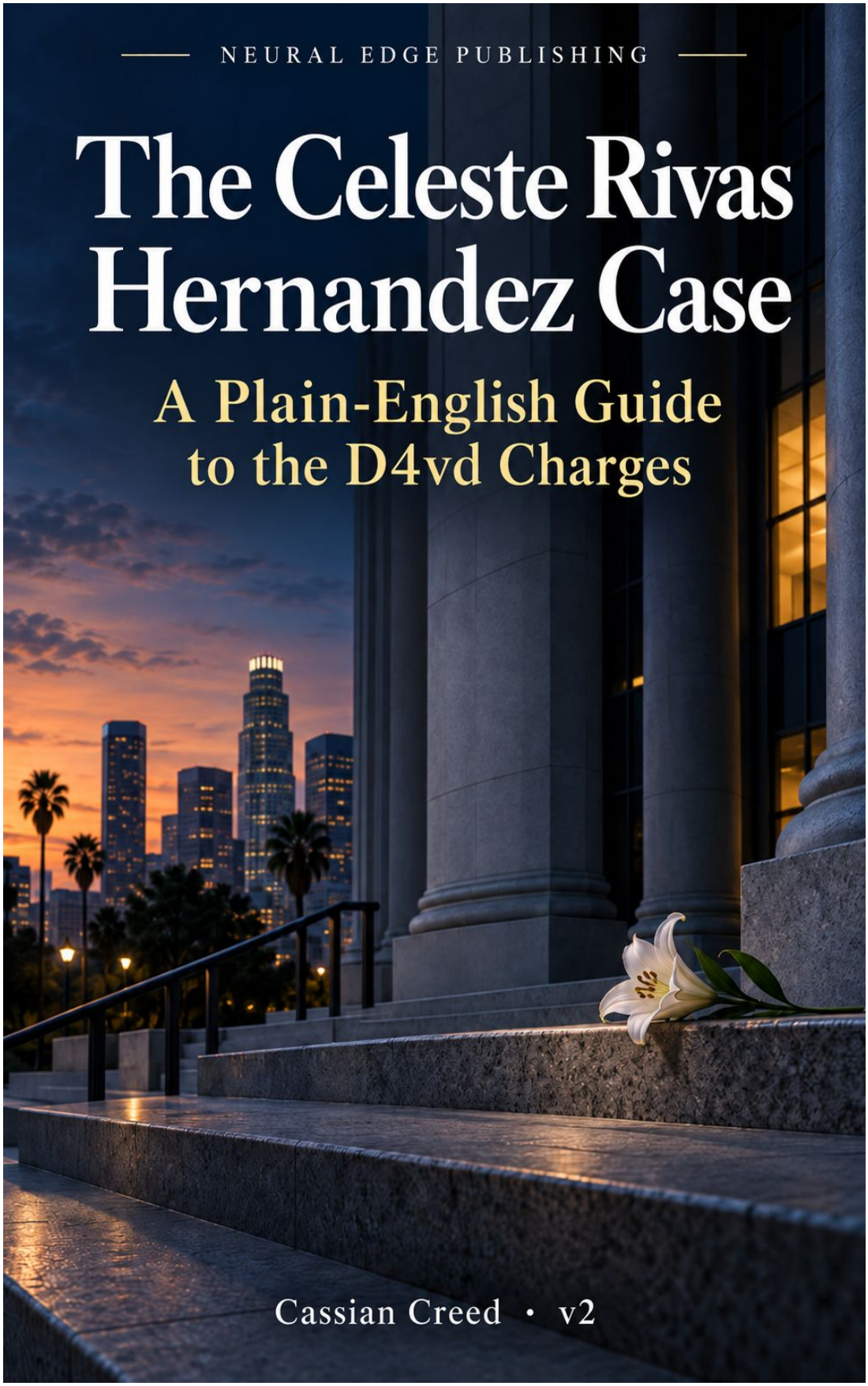


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What's inside

The Celeste Rivas Hernandez Case: A Plain-English Guide to the D4vd Charges

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Read this first
The case in five short lines.

Part 1: Who Celeste was
Her family, her town, and her birthday.

Part 2: The full timeline
From 2022 to the October 19, 2026 hearing, date by date.

Part 3: The charges, in plain words
All 3 counts and all 4 special allegations, explained.

Part 4: How the case moves from here
8 steps: status conferences, the speedy trial clock, discovery, motions, the death penalty decision, trial, outcomes, appeals.

Part 5: What each side has said
The prosecution, the defense, and Celeste's family, in their own words.

Part 6: Key questions still open
What we still do not know.

Part 7: Glossary
Court words made simple.

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Every source, listed.

The full guide is 11 pages. Next: a free sample page from inside the guide.

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Part 3: The charges, in plain words

The case number is 26CJCF02399, in Los Angeles County Superior Court.

Burke faces three counts, or charges. He also faces four "special allegations." Remember: every one of these is a claim by prosecutors. None is proven.

Count 1: First-degree murder

What it means. Murder is killing a person with "malice." That means with intent to kill, or with a deep disregard for life. First-degree murder is the most serious kind. In California, it usually means the killing was planned ahead, or done in certain listed ways.

Count 2: Continuous sexual abuse of a child under 14

What it means. This is California Penal Code section 288.5. To prove it, prosecutors must show three things:

1. The person lived with the child or had "recurring access" to the child.
2. The abuse went on for at least three months.
3. There were at least three acts against a child under 14.

Possible sentence on this count alone: 6, 12, or 16 years in state prison.

Count 3: Unlawful mutilation of human remains

What it means. This is California Health and Safety Code section 7052. It is a felony to willfully damage human remains without legal authority. It is a separate crime from the murder.

The special allegations

These are extra claims attached to the murder count. Three of them are "special circumstances." Special circumstances matter a lot. If a jury finds even one true, the only sentences allowed are death or life in prison without parole.

- **Murder of a witness.** The claim is that the victim was a witness to a crime and was killed to stop her from testifying. Prosecutors say Celeste was a witness to the abuse charged in Count 2.
- **Murder for financial gain.** The claim is that the killing was meant to protect money. Prosecutors say Burke acted to protect a profitable music career.
- **Murder by lying in wait.** The claim is that the killer watched and waited, hid his purpose, and then struck by surprise.

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